

Loai Shaheen

loai.shaheen@gmail.com

github.com/LoaiShaheen

(519)-500-2507

Summary

Senior Backend Specialist with 6+ years of experience engineering and scaling high-performance APIs using Node.js, NestJS, and GraphQL. Expert in database architecture (PostgreSQL, MongoDB) and event-driven systems (Kafka). Proven ability to own mission-critical services, lead platform migrations, and resolve complex production issues independently. A reliable problem-solver for companies needing to build, fix, or scale their backend infrastructure.

Technical Skills

- **Languages:** JavaScript / TypeScript, Java, C, C++, SQL
- **Frameworks & Tools:** Node.js, NestJS, Express.js, GraphQL, Prisma, MikroORM, TypeORM, Kafka, Docker, Heroku, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
- **Concepts:** API Design, Distributed Systems, System Architecture, Event-Driven Design, CI/CD, Serverless Functions, Unit & Integration Testing
- **Soft Skills:** Cross-functional collaboration, mentoring, problem-solving, production support, Agile methodologies

Professional Experience

Senior Node.js Developer (Full-Stack)

Emtec Inc · Jan 2022 – Sept 2024

- Senior fullstack developer for a central service domain critical to multiple upstream systems
- Investigated and resolved high-priority production issues, minimizing downtime and reducing incident impact across the platform
- Engineered and launched a full auditing system using NestJS to track user activity across a high-traffic application.
- Acted as interim team lead for a 10-person dev team; facilitated sprint planning, distributed tasks, and aligned deliverables across cross-functional teams
- Mentored junior/intermediate developers through pair programming, code reviews, and walkthroughs
- Supported knowledge sharing through internal documentation and workshops on system architecture and infrastructure processes
- Coordinated directly with product, client, and offshore teams to ensure timely and correct delivery of features and fixes
- Onboarded the incoming team lead and ensured smooth knowledge transfer of workflows and codebase architecture

Backend Developer

Driverseat.io · Dec 2018 – Nov 2021

- Designed and implemented a scalable API platform using NestJS, GraphQL, and multiple iterations of ORM and databases (Prisma/MongoDB → MikroORM/PostgreSQL)
- Owned the development of core features, including authentication, permissions, vehicle inventory, lead management, and communication systems (SMS/Email)
- Architected a mobile pass system (Google Pay / Apple Wallet) with full lifecycle management via serverless webhooks
- Independently architected and executed a full backend platform migration from MongoDB to PostgreSQL, containerizing services with Docker to increase performance and scalability.
- Delivered and maintained multiple GraphQL microservices deployed to Heroku
- Built a webhook-based inventory tracker for car dealerships, enabling real-time synchronization across clients
- As the sole backend developer, I took full ownership of the entire API lifecycle, including design, testing, deployment, performance tuning, and 99.9% uptime.

Education

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

University of Guelph · Sept 2013 – Apr 2018

Relevant Courses:

- Systems Analysis & Design
- Algorithm Analysis & Design
- Discrete Structures in Computing
- Object-Oriented Programming

Volunteer Experience

Levant Canada · 2018 – Present

- Co-organized the **Syrian Film Festival**, coordinating screenings, guest speakers, and logistics with community partners
- Provided resettlement support to refugee families including housing, banking, government paperwork, and integration into local communities